

Unit 2 Assessment

Journeys and Maps Assessment

Grade 3 Social Studies | Age of Exploration | Weeks 4–6

Name: _____

Date: _____

Part A: Knowledge Check

Choose the best answer.

1. Which of these was a reason European explorers set out on long voyages?

- A. To build museums
- B. To find faster trade routes to Asia
- C. To learn how to read maps
- D. To study the weather

2. A compass helps sailors by:

- A. Measuring how high the sun is
- B. Showing which direction is north
- C. Drawing coastlines on a map
- D. Telling the time of day

3. An astrolabe helped explorers figure out:

- A. How fast the wind was blowing
- B. How far north or south they were
- C. How deep the ocean was
- D. What language people spoke

4. What happened when Columbus sailed west from Spain in 1492?

- A. He reached China
- B. He landed in the Caribbean, thinking it was Asia
- C. He sailed around the world
- D. He discovered the compass

5. Why is Magellan's voyage important?

- A. He invented the astrolabe
- B. He discovered Florida
- C. His crew completed the first trip all the way around the world
- D. He drew the first map of Africa

6. The Columbian Exchange was:

- A. A trade route across the Sahara
- B. The movement of plants, animals, and foods between the Americas and Europe
- C. A type of compass
- D. A map drawn by Columbus

7. Exploration only had positive consequences for everyone involved.

- A. True
- B. False

Part B: Source Task

Read the source description. Then answer the questions.

Source: A portolan chart from the 1500s. It is a hand-drawn sea chart showing coastlines, compass lines radiating from central points, and notes about harbors and winds. The chart was made by a sailor who had traveled the route himself.

8. This portolan chart is a primary source because:

- A. It was written in a textbook
- B. It was created by someone who traveled the route
- C. It is very old
- D. It shows compass lines

9. Name two things a sailor could learn from this portolan chart. Explain how each detail would help on a voyage.

Part C: Constructed Response

Answer in complete sentences.

10. Exploration had both positive and negative consequences. Name one positive consequence and one negative consequence. Explain each.

Part D: Virtue Reflection

11. The assessment guide connects this unit to courage, perseverance, and responsibility. Pick one. Explain how an explorer or a curator of an exploration exhibit would show that virtue.

Section	Points
Part A: Knowledge Check (Q1–7)	7 pts
Part B: Source Task (Q8–9)	7 pts
Part C: Constructed Response (Q10)	6 pts
Part D: Virtue Reflection (Q11)	4 pts
Total	24 pts

Unit 2 Assessment — Answer Key

Journeys and Maps Assessment

Part A (7 pts, 1 each)

1. B — Find faster trade routes to Asia
2. B — Showing which direction is north
3. B — How far north or south they were
4. B — Landed in Caribbean, thought it was Asia
5. C — His crew completed first trip around the world
6. B — Movement of plants/animals/foods between Americas and Europe
7. B — False — exploration also harmed Native peoples through disease, land seizure, and forced labor

Part B (7 pts)

8. B — Created by someone who traveled the route (1 pt)
9. (6 pts) **Secure:** Names 2 details (coastlines, compass lines, harbor notes, wind info) and explains how each helps sailing (e.g., coastlines show where land is, compass lines help keep direction). **Developing:** Names 2 but weak explanation. **Beginning:** Names 1 or general.

Part C (6 pts)

10. **Secure:** Names one positive (e.g., Columbian Exchange brought new foods) AND one negative (e.g., diseases killed Native peoples, land taken) with explanation. **Developing:** Names both but one is vague. **Beginning:** Only one side or no explanation.

Part D (4 pts)

11. **Secure:** Names virtue + specific example (e.g., courage = sailing into unknown waters with no guarantee of return; responsibility = an honest exhibit must include consequences, not just discoveries). **Developing:** Virtue + general connection. **Beginning:** Names virtue only.